

make the title accurately reflect your blog's content, or try and come up with a genuinely creative one!

3.2 Topic, Focus, Style, Structure

We're assuming here that you aren't intending to write something like a personal diary, which millions of bloggers do. If that is indeed your intent, you can afford to style your content any way you like—there are no tips we need to give you, because it's entirely personal.

What we are assuming is that you want to make a name for yourself, be someone in the blogosphere. That you want to write a blog that will educate and entertain, and that people will want to come back to—regularly.

In this latter case, you *need* to decide on a topic. Personal blogs can be pretty random, but like we said, blogs of the latter type should have a topic, a focus.

We're not saying every single post should be focused. But it's a good thing if many or most of them are. The reason for this is that readers come to expect something from your blog. Say you have a technology-focused blog with an RSS feed, and people subscribe to it. They don't want to see posts about your dog popping up every now and then, do they? A little digression now and then, though, is strictly OK. Occasional digressions of the personal kind can lend character, if done right.

If you want to write about two or more things on the same blog, it's a good idea to segregate them into sections. The blog will seem pretty random otherwise, which is not a good thing if you're into serious blogging. Unless you deliberately want to make a totally random blog; but in this case, you need to have the writing skills to grip the reader's attention—which can only develop over time. If you're a first-time writer, you're better off keeping your